

Action plan

Turn your concern into action. **20** simple things you can do now, that can make a significant impact in our War on Terror:

- **1 MARKET SURVEY**
Check whether markets you go to are secure. Start a boycott campaign if they are not.
- **2 LEARN FIRST AID**
Enroll in a first aid course so you can help in an emergency till medical professionals arrive.
- **3 BADGER YOUR MLA**
Push your local MLA for more public security measures.
- **4 COMMUNITY WARDENS**
Volunteer to help in policing your neighbourhood by reporting suspicious activities.
- **5 DONATE FREELY**
Look out for genuine charities that are supporting victims of terror and donate generously.
- **6 TAB ON THE POLICE**
Visit your police station and check if it has proper facilities, manpower and equipment to meet the challenge.
- **7 BE WELL PREPARED**
Undergo a drill on how to deal with terrorists. Check with your civic authorities where to go.
- **8 PROOF OF ID**
Start a campaign to have every citizen register under a national ID card system.
- **9 REJECT CRIMINALS**
Pledge not to elect a candidate with a criminal track record.
- **10 PAY YOUR FINES**
Instead of bribing officials, pay the fine if you are penalised.
- **11 MONITOR SECURITY**
Urge the management of your children's school and your office to organise copies of the buildings' blueprints.
- **12 WATCH THY NEIGHBOUR**
Create a neighbourhood watch. Report suspicious activities and people to the police.
- **13 BE WELL-EQUIPPED**
Get the details of your Residents' Welfare Association for use in emergencies.
- **14 CREATE AN SOS HUB**
Make a list of the emergency care centres in your area with addresses, contact numbers.
- **15 BE DOUBLY SURE**
Employ people or rent out houses only after verification.
- **16 CREATE NODES**
Define aggregation points in the neighbourhood where people can collect in emergencies.
- **17 MAP IT OUT**
Develop alternate routes to and from work and school.
- **18 COME FORWARD**
Depose as a witness if you have observed terror attacks.
- **19 BE PATIENT**
Expect delays and baggage searches at public places and travel facilities.
- **20 EMERGENCY PLAN**
Develop a family emergency plan and practice it with friends.

could also enroll in first aid classes so that in times of a crisis you know what to do.

It's time you take the lead by paying fines for violations. Don't give bribes. At a time when people are calling for capital punishment for terrorist acts, how many times have we decided to be part of the judicial process that can take these crimes to their logical end? High-profile cases do not reach their logical conclusion, due to back-tracking by witnesses. We should, therefore, depose fearlessly before a court if we witness a crime.

Also, if you believe our politicians should be made aware that vote bank politics can no longer be employed to the detriment of national security, you need to pressure them to change their attitude. Our bureaucrats and the police too need to be told that half measures will not do; we need a fool-proof system that protects the common people. Peoples' movements are an incredibly powerful tool for bringing about change and the powers that be are fully aware of the fact that the Indian public is angry and demands systemic change. You can help bring about the change you want, the change we need, the change we believe in.

The War on Terror: The Agenda for Action was put together by an INDIA TODAY team consisting of Raj Chengappa, Bhavna Vij-Aurora, Sandeep Unnithan, Saurabh Shukla, Shafi Rahman, Mihir Srivastava, Aditi Pai and Swati Mathur with bureau support and a team from its sister concern MAIL TODAY, comprising of Manoj Joshi, Anupam Srivastava and Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

Get the full text of the Agenda on January 12. Click www.indiatoday.in/war

